betraying his country, spent almost twelve years as a recluse in New York, Maryland and neighbouring Virginia, where his extended family lives. A senior officer codenamed Delta neither confirmed nor denied any role the R&AW might have played to eliminate the traitor. He did, however, say that Singh couldn't bear the guilt of betraying his country after his US dream collapsed, thanks to the CIA's use and throw policy.

'Singh was left in the cold. He had told his children and US-based relatives that there was a threat to his life in India. Despite so much material about his treachery available in the public domain, his relatives revered him as a loving and kind-hearted person. His death is seen as the closure of the case that was vigorously pursued till 2007. The betrayal of Ra-binder Singh is one that R&AW would rather like to forget,' said Delta.

R&AW IN SHACKLES

Sometime in early 1990, the Indian government negotiated a defence deal for fighter aircraft from a developed country. Since the Indian embassy had to act as a coordinator, the ambassador asked a R&AW officer to help him finalise the deal. The officer readily agreed to activate a long-term asset who could swing the deal in favour of the Indian government. In the meantime, the bureaucrats in Delhi were about to clinch the contract through an Indian dealer for Rs 110 crore.

In April 1990, the R&AW officer returned to the ambassador, informing him the deal could be a little sweeter at Rs 65 crore, thanks to his shadowy asset. The ambassador duly informed New Delhi of this massive discount.